

# Utku Ceylan

## SECURITY RESEARCHER

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### PROFILE

Security researcher focused on Linux systems and Vulnerability research. Discovered and reported a CVSS 9.8 authorization flaw in LiderAhenk (Pardus ecosystem) allowing arbitrary privileged command execution on remote managed systems. Confirmed and patched by the vendor, coordinated with CERT-TR. Nine additional findings submitted under responsible disclosure across the Pardus/ETAP ecosystem, in collaboration with TÜBİTAK BİLGEM (Teknofest Pardus 2026).

### EXPERIENCE

#### Independent Security Researcher

June 2024 - Present

- Identified a critical authorization vulnerability (CWE-862) in LiderAhenk: the broker enforces no ACL between agents, allowing any authenticated agent to publish commands to another agent's topic. Because credentials can be obtained from installing ahenk agent, this effectively grants unauthenticated remote command execution across managed endpoints.
- Methodology: noticed the agent had no client-side authorization checks and hypothesized the broker might not enforce this either; confirmed it by provisioning a second agent with credentials extracted from a standard ETAP VM, then publishing crafted commands to another agent's pulsar topic.
- Vendor confirmed and remediated; coordinated with CERT-TR; MITRE CVE assignment pending.
- Conducted independent security research on the Pardus ecosystem in collaboration with Pardus and TÜBİTAK BİLGEM teams as part of Teknofest Pardus 2026.
- Submitted 10 security findings affecting the Pardus & ETAP ecosystem via responsible disclosure.

#### Cybersecurity & Software Team Lead, ThinkTank Software (School Team)

September 2025 - Present

- Lead the technical planning, architecture, and coordination of cybersecurity projects.
- Conduct security research on open-source software and guide vulnerability assessment activities within the team.
- Organize internal CTF events.
- Contribute to the design and development of multiple projects.

### PROJECTS

#### ahenk-debug

Linux diagnostic CLI designed for troubleshooting Pardus ETAP environments. Provides identity validation, broker connectivity testing, service health analysis, ETA API verification, and automated reporting.

#### Walkie

Python-based p2p encrypted LAN communication platform featuring automatic peer discovery, secure messaging, and voice communication without centralized infrastructure.

#### Portfolio Website

Interactive portfolio website presenting security research, projects, and technical documentation through a Linux-inspired desktop interface. (linuxizm.website).

### HIGHLIGHTS

10 vulnerabilities submitted.  
1 vendor-confirmed vulnerability (MITRE CVE pending)  
Multiple disclosure coordinated with CERT-TR  
Contributor - Teknofest Pardus 2026  
Active in CTF competitions

### SKILLS

#### PROGRAMMING

Python  
Shell Script

#### SECURITY

Vulnerability Research  
Linux Security  
Access Control Analysis  
Dynamic Analysis  
Responsible Disclosure  
Network/Protocol Analysis

#### LINUX & SYSTEMS

Linux Internals  
System Debugging  
Debian Packaging  
Linux CLI Development

#### TOOLS

Git  
Docker  
GitHub Actions

### EDUCATION

#### Borsa İstanbul Başakşehir Vocational and Technical Anatolian High School

Computer Technologies  
İstanbul, Türkiye

### LANGUAGES

Turkish Native  
English B2 (Upper Intermediate)